CROCHET PATTERN

Cream Snowflake Hanging Ornament

A starched lace crochet snowflake on a beaded cord with a tassel



SKILL LEVEL	FINISHED SIZE	YARN	HOOK
Intermediate	≈ 20 cm (7.9 in) plus an 8 cm loop	DK cotton · 1 colour	2.5 mm (US B/1–C/2)

A six-arm lace snowflake in three joined rounds — dc ring, dc and chain spaces, then picot-tipped arms — starched flat and hung on a beaded cord above a cream tassel.

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MATERIALS · GAUGE · ABBREVIATIONS

Before You Begin

Materials & Tools

Yarn A	DK (#3) cotton, cream or white — approx. 15 m (16 yd), about 7 g — 1 ball of 50 g (about 115 m) is enough
Hook	2.5 mm (US B/1–C/2)
Beads	3 gold-tone beads 6 mm (hole at least 2.5 mm); 2 natural wooden beads 12 mm (hole at least 3 mm). Both cord strands must pass through each bead together — test before you start.
Notions	fabric starch or white craft glue, rust-proof pins, blocking board, tapestry needle, stiff card, scissors

Gauge

GAUGE 22 sc and 24 rows/rnds = 10 cm (4 in) in single crochet with a 2.5 mm hook. Gauge is not critical for an ornament, but work firmly so that stuffing does not show and flat pieces keep their shape; sizes depend on your tension.

How to swatch: Optional density check: ch 12, then work 10 rows of sc on 11 sts. The square should measure about 5 cm (2 in) wide and 4 cm (1.6 in) tall. If it is larger or you see gaps between stitches, use a smaller hook.

Finished Measurements

Part	Width	Height
Snowflake (blocked, tip to tip)	≈ 5.6 cm (2.2 in)	≈ 6.4 cm (2.5 in)
Tassel	–	9 cm (3.5 in)

CHOOSING A SIZE One size. For a larger ornament use light worsted (#4) cotton and a 3 mm hook; for a smaller one use sport-weight cotton and a 2 mm hook. Beads and tassel length can be changed freely.

Abbreviations (US terms)

ch	chain	**sp**	space
sc	single crochet	**st(s)**	stitch(es)
sl st	slip stitch	**rnd(s)**	round(s)
dc	double crochet	**rep**	repeat
MR	magic ring		

Pattern Notes

- Terms: US crochet terms are used throughout; UK makers: US sc is the UK double crochet.
- Stitch counts: the number in parentheses at the end of a row or round is the number of stitches you have when it is finished. Tick the box when you finish each step.
- Spiral rounds (magic-ring pieces with no "Join"): do not join or turn; mark the first stitch of each round and move the marker up.
- Joined rounds (the round says "Join"): unless the round says otherwise, start with ch 1 (does not count as a stitch) and finish with a sl st into the first stitch.
- Rows: ch 1 at the end of a row, before turning, does not count as a stitch.
- Right side: for pieces in rounds, the outside of the rounds; for pieces in rows, choose the neater side and mark it. "Wrong sides together" means the marked right sides face out.
- Tails: leave a 20 cm (8 in) tail on pieces that will be sewn; weave in all other ends as you go.

Techniques

Magic ring (MR) — Wrap the yarn twice around two fingers, insert the hook under both strands, pull up a loop and ch 1 (does not count as a stitch). Work the stitches of Rnd 1 over both strands, then pull the tail firmly to close the centre.

Picot — Ch 3, then sl st into the 3rd ch from the hook (the first of the three chains).

Tassel neck wrap — Lay a 5 cm loop of the wrapping strand along the tassel, pointing down. Wrap the long end tightly around tassel and loop, from the top down. Pass the end through the loop, then pull the short tail at the top until the loop disappears under the wraps. Trim both ends and hide them in the skirt.

Order of Work

- Read Before You Begin and gather the beads; check that both cord strands pass through every bead.
- Crochet: Snowflake.
- Make the tassel and tie the hanging cord into it (Tassel).
- String beads and pieces on the cord, tie the knot and the hanging loop (Assembly & Finishing).

YARN A (CREAM) · MAKE 1

Snowflake

Three joined rounds: a dc ring, a round of dc and ch-2 spaces, and a round with six arms (each ending in a three-picot tip) alternating with six small picot points.

☐	**Rnd 1**	Ch 3 (counts as the first dc), 11 dc in MR. Join with a sl st to the top of the ch-3.	**(12)**
☐	**Rnd 2**	Ch 5 (counts as dc + ch 2), *dc in next dc, ch 2*; rep from * 10 more times. Join with a sl st to the 3rd ch of the ch-5.	**(12 dc, 12 ch-2 sps)**
☐	**Rnd 3**	Sl st into the first ch-2 sp. *In this ch-2 sp work the arm: sc, ch 6, sl st in 4th ch from hook, (ch 3, sl st in the same ch) twice, sl st in each of the next 2 ch, sc in the same ch-2 sp. In the next ch-2 sp work a small point: sc, picot, sc*; rep from * 5 more times. Join with a sl st to the first sc and fasten off.	**(6 arms, 6 small points)**

BLOCKING Pin the snowflake on a board, pinning every arm tip and each tip picot. Spray with fabric starch (or dab on a mix of 1 part white craft glue and 1 part water) and let it dry completely before unpinning.

YARN A (CREAM)

Tassel

Make the tassel when the crochet pieces are finished. The hanging cord is tied into its top, so it runs up through the whole ornament and is anchored in the tassel.

☐	**Step 1**	Cut a piece of stiff card 10 cm (3.9 in) tall. Wrap Yarn A (cream) around the card 40 times, keeping the wraps side by side and not too tight. Cut the yarn at the bottom edge.
☐	**Step 2**	Cut the hanging cord: one 90 cm (35 in) length of Yarn A. Slide it under all the wraps along the top edge of the card so that its middle sits there, and tie it in a tight square knot around the wraps. Both cord ends now point upwards.
☐	**Step 3**	Cut through all the wraps along the bottom edge of the card and remove the card. Let the strands hang down from the cord knot.
☐	**Step 4**	Tassel neck: cut a 70 cm length of Yarn A. Measure 2 cm down from the top fold and wrap it tightly 8 times around the bundle (see Tassel neck wrap in Techniques).
☐	**Step 5**	Trim the skirt evenly to 9 cm (3.5 in) from the top fold. Hold it over steam (or dampen it) and comb the strands straight with your fingers; let it dry hanging.

Assembly & Finishing

- Thread both cord ends together through a large-eye tapestry needle (or a bead needle with a big eye). Work upwards from the tassel.
- String, from the tassel upwards: 1 wooden bead → 1 gold bead → the snowflake → 1 gold bead → 1 wooden bead → 1 gold bead.
- Snowflake: hang it with one arm pointing up. Pass the needle through the chain stem of the bottom arm, weave through 3 dc of the centre ring on the back, and out through the chain stem of the top arm.
- Push everything down snugly onto the tassel so there are no gaps. Holding both cord ends together, tie one overhand knot right above the top bead to lock the stack.
- Hanging loop: tie the two cord ends together with a square knot so that the loop measures 8 cm (3 in) from the overhand knot to the top. Trim the ends to 5 mm and add a drop of fabric glue to the knot if you like.

SAFETY This is a decoration, not a toy, and not suitable for children under 3 years. Beads and cords are a choking and strangling hazard: hang it out of reach of babies, young children and pets.

Checkpoints & Troubleshooting

Count your stitches at these points; the numbers match the rows above.

Piece	After	Stitches
Snowflake	Rnd 1	12
Snowflake	Rnd 3	6 arms, 6 small points

- One stitch too many or too few: check the last increase or decrease round, and that you did not work into the slip-stitch join or the ch 1 at the start of a row.
- Piece cups or ripples: your tension differs from the gauge; change hook size by 0.25–0.5 mm rather than the stitch counts.
- Stuffing shows through: use a smaller hook, or stuff a little less firmly.
- Flat pieces curl: pin them out, mist with water (or starch) and let them dry flat.
- Cord will not pass through a bead: thread one strand at a time with a fine needle, or use beads with larger holes.

THANK YOU Thank you for making this ornament. Happy crocheting!